

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

HEIRS APPARENT

The fifth generation of the Nehru-Gandhi clan seems to be tiptoeing onto the political stage, with Rahul Gandhi giving nephew Raihan a cameo in a Diwali video. Both Raihan and sister Miraya were also spotted cheering on their mother, Priyanka Gandhi-Vadra, who is contesting the Lok Sabha bypoll in Wayanad, Kerala. Currently, Raihan, a visual artist, and Miraya, a budding diver and former basketball champ, are juggling their artistic passions with occasional public appearances. At 24 and 22, respectively, they're still shy of the minimum age of 25 to contest an election, but the recent outings have had tongues wagging about a possible "soft launch" in politics.



Speaker in a Squeeze

BJP leader, assembly speaker and dairy king from north Gujarat Shankar Chaudhary finds himself in a political pickle. After the party lost the Banaskantha LS seat to Congress's Geniben Thakor, the stakes are sky-high in the Vav assembly bypoll. The Congress has fielded a Rajput candidate, the BJP a Thakor while Chaudhary community stalwart and party rebel Mavjibhai Patel is running as an independent. Endorsing the party's Thakor candidate over a strong contender from his own Chaudhary clan is giving Shankar quite the headache. If the BJP falters, it could dent the image of one of Gujarat's most ambitious politicians.

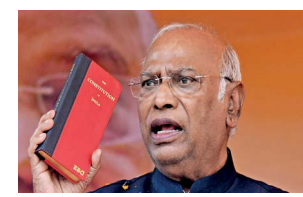
Chhat Charmer



West Bengal CM **Mamata Banerjee** has added yet another feather to her cap, penning and composing a song for Chhat Puja. Mamata, who famously led a Bengali nationalist campaign against the "outsider BJP" in 2021, has long boasted of her multilingual talents and her prowess as a poet, painter, singer and so on. Her latest ditty, though, is a rather single-minded ode in Hindi, invoking deities over and over again with a sprinkling of safety tips for riverbank revellers. But for many loyalists, the real eyebrow-raiser this festive season was the huge Chhat Puja greeting in Hindi, spelled out in fairy lights atop the secretariat building—a surprising choice for someone who's usually waving the flag of Bengali pride.

CONSTITUTION CLASH

In the theatre of Indian politics, even the "red book" of the Constitution is fair game. Recently, Prime Minister Narendra Modi took the stage to denounce Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's crimson-bound copy of the Constitution as an 'empty' gesture—he alleged the book was filled with blank pages and, horror of horrors, was a blatant appeal to "urban Naxals" and "anarchists". Congress chief **Mallikarjun Kharge** was quick with the comeback, reminding the public that Modi himself had presented a red-jacketed copy of the Constitution to then president Ram Nath Kovind in 2017. Kharge didn't hold back on the taunts either, suggesting the PM needed a refresher course in primary school to understand what's written in the Constitution.



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Reddy Revelry

Telangana's **A. Revanth Reddy** famously became chief minister without ever being a minister. Now he is set to lead the Congress government's first anniversary in power celebrations. The festivities kicked off on November 14, marking the birth anniversary of India's first PM, Jawaharlal Nehru, and will culminate on December 9—the day UPA chairperson and Congress president Sonia Gandhi supposedly conceded statehood for Telangana in 2013 and, coincidentally, her birthday. Guess Revanth knows where the power really lies.



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Kaushik Deka with Arkamoy Datta Majumdar, Jumana Shah and Amarnath K. Menon